

THE NOHO RAG – EPISODE 205
EXPO OUTBREAK!

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FADE IN:

EXT. CONVENTION CENTER

Kelly Mae is preparing for her live remote on air. She's pulling hairs off her blouse and fluffing her hair while she speaks into her ear piece.

The camera flounders around zooming in on various things as it prepares for the live shot as well.

We catch de-contextual glimpses of KM.

KELLY MAE

What do you think the odds are he went?

(beat)

I was on WebMD all night.

(beat)

I know what I'm talking about.

(beat)

It's in the eyes.

Dr. Eliza Harold and a hazmat suited person stand near the entrance to the convention center.

KELLY MAE (CONT'D)

Bob is in there, Olivia.

(beat)

I can feel it.

By this time the camera is focused in on Kelly Mae, ready to go live.

KELLY MAE (CONT'D)

I'm reporting on a quarantine that was probably started by my boss.

(beat)

What?

(beat)

No Olivia, I'm not going to say that on air.

(beat)

I've done plenty of live remotes.

(beat)

Yeah. It's kinda my thi-

(beat)

What?

(sotto)

Why didn't you-

(beat)

That's right Dane.

NOHO STINGER

INT. BEHIND THE CAMERA - LATER

Olivia stands behind the camera and speaks into her headset.

OLIVIA
Annnnnd...
(beat)
Smash to commercial.

Olivia rests her headphones on her neck. Olivia settles into annoyed attack mode, her target: Dane at the desk.

OLIVIA (CONT'D)
Yeah. I can do stuff.

DANE
Hey look, I just don't feel
comfortable doing this show with
the **real** producer down for the
count.
(beat)
Did they teach **you** how to produce
news at **writing** school?

Olivia stares blankly. She slowly raises her headphones to her ears.

OLIVIA
We're going live.

Olivia uses her hand to count down.

OLIVIA (CONT'D)
In three.
(beat)
Two.

Olivia flicks Dane off as we can hear the NoHo Rag stinger.

Dane looks flummoxed at the desk.

DANE
Welcome back, NoHo.
(beat)
If you're just joining us.
(beat)
The 2016 Pacific Lifestyle and
Leisure expo is quarantined under a
suspected outbreak of Acute
Pneumococcal Alpaca Fever.
(beat)
(MORE)

DANE (CONT'D)

The CDC is on site, investigating the matter.

(beat)

The Rag's own Kelly Mae Greenblatt is live at the convention center.

(beat)

KM, I can't imagine what it's like inside.

INT. CONVENTION CENTER - NO TIME PASSED

The convention center is empty. Devoid of motion. It looks like a nice place to spend an afternoon.

A chair sits as part of the scene, Bob is resting in it, comatose.

Bob sits motionless, head leaning back. Eyes closed.

Suddenly, he wakes.

Bob gasps as he looks around. He's sitting in an evacuated convention center hall.

Departure by the Moody Blues cues.

He rubs his eyes and attempts to sit more upright in the chair.

Bob sinks back into the chair and his eyes goes wide.

SLAM. Bob's world drips with technicolor.

His head goes fuzzy, time slows, speech slurs.

BOB

This isn't home.

Bob's words stretch.

HUNTER (O.S.)

Home? No, this isn't home.

(beat)

It's a madhouse.

HUNTER S. THOMPSON walks into Bob's hallucinatory gaze.

HUNTER (CONT'D)

The wolves.

(beat)

They're at the door.

(beat)

And they're here for you!

BOB
Which way out?

Bob's words lift and twist on the wind.

As Hunter begins, Bob stands, looking noticeably healthier and wearing a bandana.

HUNTER
I know the way.
(beat)
But listen:
(beat)
It won't be easy.

Bob looks resolute.

HUNTER (CONT'D)
(over the Bob look)
I could see in his eyes that no
matter what was coursing through
his veins...
(beat)
He was ready.

CUT TO:

EXT. FOREST - LATER

HUNTER
You'll face three trials on your
trip.
(beat)
First, watch your step.

Bob ambles into frame, then stumbles on an exposed root in the path.

HUNTER (CONT'D)
Here the trip turns sour.
(beat)
Your breakfast.
(beat)
You'll see it again.

Bob heaves next to a tree.

HUNTER (CONT'D)
Now, don't think you're in the
clear.

Bob walks through the inner forest.

HUNTER (CONT'D)
The hardest is yet to come.
(beat)
You'll be confronted by two
grotesque creatures.

Doc and Astro appear on the path before Bob.

HUNTER (CONT'D)
They'll overwhelm you.

Doc and Astro greet Bob. He bends down to scratch Astro's belly.

Doc approaches and goes in tail wagging. Bob sees him and greets him. Doc rolls over on his back. Bob does the same.

HUNTER (CONT'D)
Pin you to the ground.

As Bob lay on the ground, Doc climbs into position on Bob's chest and proceeds to lick Bob's face.

HUNTER (CONT'D)
Don't let them take you down.
(beat)
Don't do it, man!

Bob returns to Hunter, exhausted.

BOB
I couldn't do it...
(beat)
They were too fuzzy...

Hunter looks annoyed.

HUNTER
Damn it man!
(beat)
Well...
(beat)
Have you tried the front door?

It dawns on Bob.

BOB
Of course!

Bob ambles off.

INT. DESK

Dane slouches at the desk, looking off to the side of the camera.

DANE
(to Olivia)
What?
(beat)
What does that mean?
(beat)
That hand signal.
(beat)
Does that mean we're on?
(beat)
Yes?!

Dane adjusts quickly back to polished newsman.

DANE (CONT'D)
Thanks for sticking with us NoHo!

INT. BEHIND THE CAMERA

Olivia stands head in hand. She rubs her face then talks into her headset.

OLIVIA
Alright Kelly Mae, we just got the
ALL CLEAR from the CDC.
(beat)
So we're go for interview.
(beat)
Meet Dr. Harold inside.

KELLY MAE (O.S.)
What?!
(beat)
Inside?!

INT. DESK

DANE
We now go back live to Kelly Mae
with the latest on the convention
quarantine.
(beat)
KM?

EXT. CONVENTION CENTER - LATER

Kelly Mae stands, mouth agape, finger to ear.

KELLY MAE

Yes, I'm now being told we have an
all clear!

(beat)

Let's head **inside** for a **quick**
comment from Southwest regional CDC
director.

(beat)

Dr. Eliza Harold.

Kelly Mae walks hurriedly towards the front entrance.

CUT TO:

INT. CONVENTION CENTER ENTRANCE - NO TIME PASSED

Bob ambles towards the front door.

The sound of the ocean and seagulls rises in the mix.

A faint smile crests Bob's face.

BOB

(calmly)

Home.

Kelly Mae rushes towards the entrance and sees Bob standing
inside.

Through the glass, Kelly Mae exclaims

KELLY MAE

Bob?

(beat)

I knew it!

Bob pushes the door open and brushes past Kelly Mae.

KELLY MAE (CONT'D)

How could you?

Bob turns to Kelly Mae.

BOB

(satiated)

Leisure.

KELLY MAE
 Oh god, you're hallucinating!
 (beat)
 You are **the most** contagious right
 now.
 (beat)
 I have no words.

Kelly Mae sneezes. And suddenly tenses with fear. Eliza Harold sees and points. The hazmat suited person runs towards KM.

ELIZA HAROLD
 (shouting)
 Neutralize the contagion!

KELLY MAE
 Psychosomatic!
 (beat)
 Psychosomatic!

HAZMAT GUY
 Remain Calm!

The Hazmat guy tackles Kelly Mae.

KELLY MAE
 Get off me, you psycho!
 (beat)
 He's getting away.

Bob ambles away.

ELIZA HAROLD
 We got her.
 (beat)
 Situation contained.

CUT TO:

INT. NOHO RAG DESK - NO TIME PASSED

Dane sits mouth agape.

DANE
 Heck of a scoop you got there, KM!

KELLY MAE (O.S.)
 Hey! Hey! No! Get someone down
 here!

DANE
 You went with a camera man!

KELLY MAE (O.S.)
 (hurried)
 They have him inside. I don't know
 what they're going to do with him!

CUT TO:

INT. BEHIND THE CAMERA

Olivia motions to Dane to wrap up.

OLIVIA
 Wrap.
 (beat)
 It.
 (beat)
 Up.

CUT TO:

INT. DESK

DANE
 (to Olivia)
 Hey, Bob said we needed to boost
 ratings!
 (beat)
 This is how we do it!

Dane's eyes light up.

DANE (CONT'D)
 (to himself)
 Bob!
 (beat)
 You genius!

CUT TO:

EXT. BEACH AT SUNSET.

Bob stands, toes in the sand, looking blissful but still
 sweaty and beat red sick. Seriously ill.

KELLY MAE (O.S.)
 Call someone!
 (beat)
 Anyone!
 (to hazmat guy)
 Hey! I have rights!

OLIVIA

A genius would've stayed at home.

(beat)

Bob's no genius.

(beat)

He's just a crazy sick dingus.

Bob drops to the ground like a bag of bricks. A rag doll.

Big wide shot with Bob collapsed on the sand with a stupid grin cresting his sweaty face. Sun setting over the ocean.

End.